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MEMORANDUM

TO: Local Government Unit of Bacolod, Lanao del Norte

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SUBJECT: Policy Recommendations for Optimizing Household Waste Segregation under RA 9003

Rationale and Background

Despite the existence of Municipal Ordinance No. 2018-05 and the mandates of the Ecological Solid Waste Management Act (RA 9003), household waste segregation compliance in Bacolod remains sub-optimal, with functional segregation at the household source estimated at approximately 10%. The root cause of this non-compliance is not merely a lack of public awareness, but structural friction and the systemic dilution of the municipal budget. Implementing a data-driven policy shift is required to achieve a self-sustaining compliance rate within the municipality's strict ₱1.5 million annual Solid Waste Management (SWM) budget.

Key Findings

- **The "Convenience Barrier":** The primary driver of non-compliance is the "Cost of Effort," which accounts for approximately 83% of the variance in behavior. Logistical friction and the physical difficulty of segregating override pro-environmental intent
- **The Value-Action Gap:** Information, Education, and Communication (IEC) campaigns have reached a point of diminishing returns. The attitude of residents shows near-zero sensitivity, meaning that environmental awareness alone does not translate to action when systemic barriers remain high.
- **Failure of the "Status Quo" Equal Distribution:** Distributing the limited budget evenly across all seven barangays acts as a dilution mechanism. It fails to reach the required enforcement intensity to change behavior, especially in high-density urban areas like Barangay Poblacion, where compliance stagnates.

Specific Policy Recommendations

A. Transition from "Equal Distribution" to a "Sequential Saturation" Strategy

- **Action:** Cease the equitable distribution of the municipal SWM budget. Adopt a phased, sequential approach to resource allocation.
- **Implementation:** Concentrate the majority of the budget (up to 50%-90%) on one or two targeted barangays to create a "Shock and Awe" enforcement and incentive intensity. Once a target barangay reaches a "Social Tipping Point" of approximately 70% compliance, social norms will naturally take over to sustain the habit. The LGU can then safely reduce funding in that specific area to maintenance levels and rotate the heavy funding to the next non-compliant barangay.

B. Decouple Policy Instruments Based on Barangay Demographics

- **For High-Density Urban Centers (e.g., Brgy. Poblacion):** The "Urban Resource Trap" renders social pressure ineffective. Redirect the budget away from IEC and monetary incentives, and focus heavily on high-visibility enforcement to overcome anonymity and increase the perceived risk of non-compliance.
- **For Smaller/Low-Income Communities (e.g., Brgy. Babalaya, Brgy. Demologan):** Focus on manageable incentives and structural support. In small populations, the per-capita value of rewards remains meaningful and can successfully drive compliance without succumbing to budget dilution

C. Prioritize Friction Reduction Over Awareness Campaigns

- **Action:** Reallocate funds currently dedicated to general environmental awareness campaigns toward initiatives that actively reduce the physical cost of effort for households.
- **Implementation:** Invest in accessible infrastructure and structural support, recognizing that convenience and logistics dictate compliance more than pro-environmental intent.

Conclusion

The challenge of solid waste management in Bacolod is a complex socio-technical issue rather than a purely logistical one. By adopting a "Sequential Saturation" allocation of funds and tailoring extrinsic motivators to specific demographic realities, the LGU can maximize the impact of its budget and trigger self-sustaining pro-environmental social norms for long-term resilience.